

Only 8% of GCCs reach Innovation Hub maturity.

The other 92% aren't failing.

They're not allowed to succeed.

This isn't an India story. Bangalore, Kuala Lumpur, Warsaw, Manila, same fingerprint.

THE HUMAN COST

Pay isn't why your best people are leaving.

When researchers asked people why they actually left:

42%

Limited career progression

28%

Lack of ownership over outcomes

19%

Compensation

Compensation didn't even crack the top two.

THE TWO ARCHETYPES

The Clog

Keeps the center running.
Deliverables land. Every
decision still routes upward.
The center plateaus without
ever having a visible crisis,
just a permanent ceiling
dressed up as a steady state.

The Lightning Rod

**Decides, builds, and moves
without waiting for
consensus, because the
mandate already gave them
the room to.**

THE FAILURE PATTERN

A European insurer's Bangalore GCC

Competitive pay. Strong global brand. Deep technical talent.

Still lost senior engineers at 25 to 30% attrition.

Every strategic decision was made at headquarters. Its leader was a Clog by design, not by choice.

THE SUCCESS PATTERN

A US fintech's Hyderabad GCC

Hired the site head and engineering lead before the first engineer.

Documented decision rights before go live.

24 months later: highest performing engineering function, 110+ people, full ownership.

Same talent pool. Same country. Opposite outcome.

STAGE 1 | ANCHOR THE MANDATE

The charter isn't real until someone can say no.

Hyderabad had decision rights documented before hiring engineer one. Bangalore never did.

JPMorgan Chase, Manila

Renamed an entire office tower after itself. Committed to two 70,000 sqm buildings, ~20,000 employees. That's what anchoring looks like when it's real.

STAGE 2 | EMPOWER LOCAL LEADERSHIP

Decision rights move with accountability, not after it.

Standard Chartered, Kuala Lumpur

Based its global Head of Global Business Services in KL, not London.
The hub became the bank's command center for 50+ markets.

Bangalore's leaders held global titles without global authority. Every decision still routed home.

Proximity isn't ownership.

Poland

34%

leave citing lack of independence,
despite same-timezone HQ overlap

ING Hubs, Philippines

~5%

core tech attrition after full platform
ownership, vs 14 to 18% industry

Same dynamic as Bangalore and Hyderabad. Geography was never the variable.

THE NEXT THREE YEARS

The gap is widening, not narrowing.

83% of GCCs are engaging with generative AI. **58%** are investing in agentic capabilities.

Engagement isn't the same as advantage. Only centers with decision rights and cognitive ownership already in place will deploy any of it as an accelerant, not another layer of unmanaged complexity.

The technology was never the constraint.

The constraint is whether the organization has the will to let the center own something.

Full playbook: link in comments.